Defense Logistics Agency (DLA)
FY26 Small Business Innovation Research (SBIR) BAA
Release 2
Proposal Submission Instructions

INTRODUCTION

The Defense Logistics Agency's (DLA) mission has three lines of effort the DLA Small Business Innovation Program (SBIP) supports. They include supporting the **NUCLEAR ENTERPRISE** by maintaining nuclear systems readiness, qualifying alternate sources of supply, improving the quality of consumable parts, and increasing materiel availability. **FORCE READINESS & LETHALITY** through improvements to life cycle performance through technological advancement, innovation, and reengineering, mitigate single points-of-failure that threaten the readiness of weapons systems used by our Warfighters. **SUPPLY CHAIN INNOVATION & ASSURANCE** through improved lead times, reduced lifecycle costs, maintaining a secure and resilient supply chain, providing opportunities for the small business industrial base to enhance supply chain operations with technological innovations. Lastly supply chain assurance securing the microelectronics supply chain, development of a domestic supply chain for rare earth elements, the adoptions of industrial base best practices associated with counterfeit risk reduction.

Proposers responding to a topic in this solicitation must follow all general instructions provided in the Department of War (DoW) SBIR Program solicitation. DLA requirements in addition to or deviating from the DoW Program solicitation are provided in the instructions below.

Proposers are encouraged to thoroughly review the DoW solicitation and register for the DSIP Listserv to remain apprised of important programmatic and contractual changes.

- The full DoW solicitation is available on DSIP at https://www.DoWsbirsttr.mil/submissions/solicitation-documents/active-solicitations. Be sure to select the tab for the appropriate solicitation cycle.
- Register for the DSIP Listserv at: https://www.DoWsbirsttr.mil/submissions/login.

Specific questions pertaining to the administration of the DLA SBIR Program and these proposal preparation instructions should be directed to:

Defense Logistics Agency
Small Business Innovation Program (SBIP) Office DLA/J68
Email: DLASBIR2@DLA.mil

PHASE I PROPOSAL GUIDELINES

The DoW SBIR/STTR Innovation Portal (DSIP) is the official portal for DoW SBIR/STTR proposal submission. Proposers are required to submit proposals via DSIP; proposals submitted by any other means will be disregarded. Detailed instructions regarding registration and proposal submission via DSIP are provided in the DoW solicitation.

Proposal Coversheet (Volume 1)

The proposal coversheet is prepared on DSIP and in accordance with the DoW solicitation.

Technical Volume (Volume 2)

The technical volume is not to exceed 20 pages and must follow the formatting requirements provided in the DoW SBIR solicitation Any pages submitted beyond the 20-page limit within the

Technical Volume (Volume 2) will not be evaluated. If including a letter(s) of support, they should be included in Volume 5, and they will not count towards the 20-page Volume limit. Any technical data/information that should be in the Volume 2 but is contained in other Volumes will not be considered.

Content of the Technical Volume
Refer to the instructions provided in the DoW Program BAA.

Cost Volume (Volume 3)
The Phase I Base amount must not exceed $100,000. Costs for the Base must be clearly identified on the Proposal Cover Sheet (Volume 1) and in Volume 3. Proposers must utilize the excel cost volume provided during proposal submission on DSIP.

Please review the updated Percentage of Work (POW) calculation details included in the DoW solicitation. SBIR ONLY: DLA will not accept any deviation to the POW requirements / DLA will occasionally accept deviations from the POW requirements with written approval from the Funding Agreement officer. STTR ONLY: Deviations from the POW requirements are not permitted.

Company Commercialization Report (CCR) (Volume 4)
Completion of the CCR as Volume 4 of the proposal submission in DSIP is required. Please refer to the DoW solicitation for full details on this requirement. Information contained in the CCR will be considered by DLA during proposal evaluations.

Supporting Documents (Volume 5)
Volume 5 is provided for proposing SBCs to submit additional documentation to support the Coversheet (Volume 1), Technical Volume (Volume 2), and the Cost Volume (Volume 3). Please refer to the DoW solicitation for more information.

Additional DLA-specific supporting documents:

- Optional, A qualified letter of support is from a relevant commercial or Government Agency procuring organization(s) working with DLA, articulating their pull for the technology (i.e., what DLA need(s) the technology supports and why it is important to fund it), and possible commitment to provide additional funding and/or insert the technology in their acquisition/sustainment program.
- Letters of support shall not be contingent upon award of a subcontract.

The standard formal deliverables for a Phase I are the:

- Plan of Action and Milestones (POAM) with sufficient detail for monthly project tracking.
- Initial Project Summary: one-page, unclassified, non-sensitive, and non-proprietary summation of the project problem statement and intended benefits (must be suitable for public viewing).
- Monthly Status Report. A format will be provided at the Post Award Conference (PAC).
- The Technical Point of Contact (TPOC) and the Program Manager (PM) will determine a meeting schedule at the PAC. Phase I awardees can expect monthly (or more frequent) project reviews.
- Draft Final Report including major accomplishments, business case analysis, commercialization strategy, transition plan with timeline and proposed path forward for Phase II.
- Final Report including major accomplishments, business case analysis, commercialization strategy and transition plan with timeline, and proposed path forward for Phase II.
- Final Project Summary (one-page, unclassified, non-sensitive and non-proprietary summation of project results, high resolution photos or graphics intended for public viewing).
- Applicable patent documentation.

- Other deliverables as defined in the Phase I Proposal.
- Phase II Proposal is optional at the Phase I Awardee's discretion (as applicable).

Fraud, Waste and Abuse Training (Volume 6)
Fraud, Waste and Abuse training material can be found in the Volume 6 section of the proposal submission module in DSIP and must be thoroughly reviewed once per year to proceed with proposal submission.

Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries (Volume 7)
Small business concerns must complete the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries webform in Volume 7 of the DSIP proposal submission. Please be aware that the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries WILL NOT be accepted as a PDF Supporting Document in Volume 5 of the DSIP proposal submission. Do not upload any previous versions of this form to Volume 5. For additional details, please refer to the DoW Program BAA.

PHASE II PROPOSAL GUIDELINES
Per SBA Policy Directive SBIR Phase II Proposal guidance, all Phase I awardees are permitted to submit a Phase II proposal for evaluation and potential award selection, without formal invitation. Details on the due date, format, content, and submission requirements of the Phase II proposal will be provided by the DLA SBIP Program Management Office (PMO) on/around the midway point of the Phase I period of performance. Only firms who receive a Phase I award may submit a Phase II proposal.

DLA will evaluate and select Phase II proposals using the same criteria as Phase I evaluation. Funding decisions are based upon the results of work performed under a Phase I award, the Scientific & Technical Merit, Feasibility, and Commercial Potential of the Phase II proposal; Phase I final reports may be reviewed as part of the Phase II evaluation process. The Phase II proposal should include a concise summary of the Phase I effort including the specific technical problem or opportunity addressed and its importance, the objective of the Phase I effort, the type of research conducted, findings or results of this research, and technical feasibility of the proposed technology.

Due to limited funding, DLA reserves the right to limit awards under any topic and only proposals considered to be of superior quality will be funded.

Phase II Proposals should anticipate a combination of any or all the following deliverables:

- Plan of Action and Milestones (POAM) with sufficient detail for monthly project tracking.
- Initial Project Summary: one-page, unclassified, non-sensitive, and non-proprietary summation of the project problem statement and intended benefits (must be suitable for public viewing).
- Monthly Status Report. A format will be provided at the PAC.
- Meeting schedule to be determined by the Technical Point of Contact (TPOC) and PM at the PAC.
- Phase II awardees expect Monthly (minimum) Project Reviews (format provided at the PAC).
- Draft Final Report including major accomplishments, commercialization strategy and transition plan and timeline.
- Final Report including major accomplishments, commercialization strategy, transition plan, and timeline.
- Final Project Summary (one-page, unclassified, non-sensitive and non-proprietary summation of project results, non-proprietary high-resolution photos, or graphics intended for public viewing).
- Applicable patent documentation.

- Other deliverables as defined in the Phase II Proposal.

DISCRETIONARY TECHNICAL AND BUSINESS ASSISTANCE (TABA)
The DLA SBIR Program does not participate in the Technical and Business Assistance (formally the Discretionary Technical Assistance Program). Contractors should not submit proposals that include Technical and Business Assistance.

EVALUATION AND SELECTION
All proposals will be evaluated in accordance with the evaluation criteria listed in the DoW solicitation.
Use of Support Contractors in the Evaluation Process

Only government personnel with active non-disclosure agreements will officially evaluate proposals.

Non-government technical consultants (subsequently referred to as "consultants") to the government may review and provide support in proposal evaluations during source selection.

Consultants may have access to the offeror's proposals, may be utilized to review proposals, and may provide comments and recommendations to the government's decision makers. Consultants will not establish final assessments of risk and will not rate or rank offerors' proposals. They are also expressly prohibited from competing for DLA SBIR awards in the SBIR topics they review and/or on which they provide comments to the government.

All consultants are required to comply with procurement integrity laws. Consultants will not have access to proposals or pages of proposals that are properly labeled by the offerors as "FEDONLY." Pursuant to FAR 9.505-4, DLA contracts with these organizations include a clause which requires them to:

(1) Protect the offerors' information from unauthorized use or disclosure for as long as it remains proprietary and

(2) Refrain from using the information for any purpose other than that for which it was furnished. In addition, DLA requires the employees of those support contractors that provide technical analysis to the SBIR/STTR Program to execute non-disclosure agreements. These agreements will remain on file with the DLA SBIP PMO.

Consultants will be authorized access to only those portions of the proposal data and discussions that are necessary to enable them to perform their respective duties. In accomplishing their duties related to the source selection process, employees of the organizations may require access to proprietary information contained in the offerors' proposals.
All proposals will be evaluated in accordance with the evaluation criteria listed in the DoW SBIR Program BAA. DLA will evaluate and select Phase I and Phase II proposals using scientific review criteria based upon technical merit and other criteria as discussed in this Announcement document.
- DLA reserves the right to award none, one, or more than one contract under any topic.
- DLA is not responsible for any money expended by the offeror before award of any contract.
- Due to limited funding, DLA reserves the right to limit awards under any topic.
- Only proposals that DLA considers to be "Highly Acceptable" will be funded.

Please note that potential benefit to DLA will be considered throughout all the evaluation criteria and in the best value trade-off analysis. When combined, the stated evaluation criteria are significantly more important than cost or price.

It cannot be assumed that reviewers are acquainted with the firm or key individuals or any referenced experiments. Technical reviewers will base their conclusions only on information contained in the proposal. Relevant supporting data such as journal articles, literature, including government publications, etc., should be listed in the proposal and will count toward the applicable page limit.

Final Selection may require an oral presentation. This may include an in-person or virtual meeting. The two-part evaluation process is explained below:

Part I: The evaluation of the Technical Volume will utilize the Evaluation Criteria provided in the DoW SBIR BAA. Once the initial evaluations are complete, all offerors will be notified as to whether they were selected to present the slide deck portion of their proposal within 60 days of the BAA close date. Only proposals receiving a "Highly Acceptable" rating will receive an invitation to present orally.

Part II: If selected for an oral presentation, offerors shall submit a slide deck not to exceed 15 PowerPoint slides to DLASBIR@dla.mil.

- There are no set format requirements other than the 15-page maximum page length.
- It is recommended (but not required) that more detailed information is included in the technical volume and higher-level information is included in the slide deck.

Selected offerors will receive an invitation to present a slide deck (15-minute presentation time / 15-minute question and answer) in a technical question and answer forum to the DLA evaluation team via electronic media. This presentation will be evaluated by a panel against the criteria listed above and your overall presentation. DLA will evaluate the presentation for business acumen, and core business capabilities (customer engagement / presentation skills). The rating of the presentation will be a Go/No-Go rating.

Notification of the Go/No-Go rating decision will occur within 5 days of the presentation. Input on technical aspects of the proposals may be solicited by DLA from consultants and advisors who are bound by appropriate non-disclosure requirements.

The SBIP PMO will distribute selection and non-selection email notices to all firms who submit a SBIR/STTR proposal to DLA. The email will be distributed to the "Corporate Official" and "Principal Investigator" listed on the proposal coversheet. DLA cannot be responsible for notification to a company that provides incorrect information or changes such information after proposal submission.

Proposing firms will be notified of selection or non-selection status for a Phase I award within 90 days of the closing date of the topic. DLA will provide written feedback to unsuccessful offerors regarding their proposals on the non-selection notification. Only firms that receive a non-selection notification are eligible for written feedback.
Refer to the DoW solicitation for procedures to protest the Announcement.

As further prescribed in FAR 33.106(b), FAR 52.233-3, Protests after Award should be submitted to: The contracting officer identified on the subject award.

AWARD AND CONTRACT INFORMATION

Typically, the contract period of performance for Phase I should be up to 12 months and the award should not exceed $100,000. However, each topic may have a different threshold. The DLA Contracting Office utilizes a Firm-Fixed-Price (FFP) Contract for DLA Phase I Projects.

The expected budget for Phase II should not exceed $1,000,000 unless approved by the DLA Program Manager, and the duration should not exceed 24 months. Proposals for more than $1,000,000 will not be considered without written PM approval. The DLA Contracting Office utilizes a FFP/Level-of-Effort Contract for DLA Phase II Projects.

Proposals not conforming to the terms of this announcement will not be considered. DLA reserves the right to limit awards under any topic, and only those proposals that DLA determines to be of superior scientific and technical quality will be funded.

DLA reserves the right to withdraw from negotiations at any time prior to contract award.

Post Award, DLA may terminate any award at any time for any reason to include matters of national security (foreign persons, foreign influence or ownership, inability to clear the firm or personnel for security clearances, or other related issues).

Please read the entire DoW Announcement and DLA instructions carefully prior to submitting your proposal. Please go to https://www.sbir.gov/about to read the SBIR/STTR Policy Directive issued by the Small Business Administration.

USE OF FOREIGN NATIONALS (also known as Foreign Persons), GREEN CARD HOLDERS AND DUAL CITIZENS

If proposing to use foreign nationals (also known as foreign persons), they must be green card holders, and/or dual citizens. No Student or Temporary Visa holders will be approved. The offeror must identify the personnel they expect to be involved on this project, the type of visa or work permit under which they are performing, country of origin and level of involvement.

You will be asked to provide additional information during negotiations to verify the foreign citizen's eligibility to participate on a SBIR contract. Supplemental information provided in response to this paragraph will be protected in accordance with the Privacy Act (5 U.S.C. 552a), if applicable, and the Freedom of Information Act (5 U.S.C. 552(b)(6)).

Proposals submitted to export control-restricted topics and/or those with foreign nationals, dual citizens, or green card holders listed will be subject to security review during the contract negotiation process (if selected for award).

DLA reserves the right to vet all uncleared individuals involved in the project, regardless of citizenship, who will have access to Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) such as export controlled information. If the security review disqualifies a person from participating in the proposed work, the contractor may propose a suitable replacement.

In the event a proposed person and/or firm is found ineligible by the government to perform proposed work, the contracting officer will advise the offeror of any disqualifications but is not required to disclose the underlying rationale.

V. EXPORT CONTROL RESTRICTIONS

The technology within most DLA topics is restricted under export control regulations including the International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR) and the Export Administration Regulations (EAR). ITAR controls the export and import of listed defense-related material, technical data and services that provide the United States with a critical military advantage. EAR controls military, dual-use and commercial items not listed on the United States Munitions List or any other export control lists. EAR

regulates export-controlled items based on user, country, and purpose. The offeror must ensure that their firm complies with all applicable export control regulations. Please refer to the following URLs for additional information: https://www.pmddtc.state.gov/ and https://www.bis.doc.gov/index.php/regulations/export-administration-regulations-ear.

Most DLA SBIR topics are subject to ITAR and/or EAR. If the topic write-up indicates that the topic is subject to ITAR and/or EAR, your company may be required to submit a Technology Control Plan (TCP) during the contracting negotiation process.

CLAUSE H-08 PUBLIC RELEASE OF INFORMATION (Publication Approval)
Clause H-08 pertaining to the public release of information is incorporated into all DLA SBIR contracts and subcontracts without exception. Any information relative to the work performed by the contractor under DLA SBIR contracts must be submitted to DLA for review and approval prior to its release to the public. This mandatory clause also includes the subcontractor who shall provide their submission through the prime contractor for DLA's review for approval.

FLOW-DOWN OF CLAUSES TO SUBCONTRACTORS
The clauses to which the prime contractor and subcontractors are required to comply include but are not limited to the following clauses:

1) DLA clause H-08 (Public Release of Information),
2) DFARS 252.204-7000 (Disclosure of Information),
3) DFARS clause 252.204-7012 (Safeguarding Covered Defense Information and Cyber Incident Reporting), and
4) DFARS clause 252.204-7020 (NIST SP 800-171 DoW Assessment Requirements). Your proposal submission confirms that any proposed subcontract is in accordance with the clauses cited above and any other clauses identified by DLA in any resulting contract.
5) DFARS Clause 252.223-7999 Ensuring Adequate COVID-19 Safety Protocols for Federal Contractors.

OWNERSHIP ELIGIBILITY
Prior to award, DLA may request business/corporate documentation to assess ownership eligibility as related to the requirements of SBIR Program Eligibility. These documents include, but may not be limited to, the Business License; Articles of Incorporation or Organization; By-Laws/Operating Agreement; Stock Certificates (Voting Stock); Board Meeting Minutes for the previous year; and a list of all board members and officers.

If requested by DLA, the contractor shall provide all necessary documentation for evaluation prior to SBIR award. Failure to submit the requested documentation in a timely manner as indicated by DLA may result in the offeror's ineligibility for further consideration for award.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION
Classified Proposals
Classified proposals ARE NOT accepted under the DLA SBIR Program. The inclusion of classified data in an unclassified proposal is grounds for the agency to determine the proposal as non-responsive and the proposal not to be evaluated.

Contractors currently working under a classified contract must use the security classification guidance provided under that contract to verify new SBIR proposals are unclassified prior to submission.

Phase I contracts are not typically awarded for classified work. However, in some instances, work being performed on DLA SBIR/STTR contracts will require security clearances. If a DLA SBIR/STTR contract develops into or identifies classified work, the offeror must have a facility clearance, appropriate personnel clearances to perform the classified work and coordinate the DD254 with the Contract Officer and the service owning the classified data.

For more information on facility and personnel clearance procedures and requirements, please visit the Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency website at: https://www.dcsa.mil/.

Use of Acronyms
Acronyms should be spelled out the first time they are used within the technical volume (Volume 2), the technical abstract, and the anticipated benefits/potential commercial applications of the research or development sections. This will help avoid confusion when proposals are evaluated by technical reviewers.

Communication
All communication from the DLA SBIR/STTR PMO will originate from the DLASBIR2@DLA.mil email address. Please white list this address in your company's spam filters to ensure timely receipt of communications from our office.

All attachments sent via email require encryption. The firm will have to purchase External Certificate Authority (ECA) certificates to send and receive encrypted email if they do not have a Common Access Card (CAC) or Personal Identity Verification (PIV) issued. The cost is approximately $100 per year per user. This will be a Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification (CMMC) requirement for all future contracts.

ORGANIZATIONAL CONFLICTS OF INTEREST (OCI)
The basic OCI rules for contractors which support development and oversight of SBIR topics are covered in FAR 9.5 as follows (the offeror is responsible for compliance):

(1) The contractor's objectivity and judgment are not biased because of its present or planned interests which relate to work under this contract.

(2) The contractor does not obtain unfair competitive advantage by virtue of its access to non-public information regarding the government's program plans and actual or anticipated resources.

(3) The contractor does not obtain unfair competitive advantage by virtue of its access to proprietary information belonging to others.

All applicable rules under the FAR Section 9.5 apply.

If you, or another employee in your company, developed or assisted in the development of any SBIR requirement or topic, please be advised that your company may have an OCI. Your company could be precluded from an award under this BAA if your proposal contains anything directly relating to the development of the requirement or topic. Before submitting your proposal, please examine any potential OCI issues that may exist with your company to include subcontractors and understand that if any exist, your company may be required to submit an acceptable OCI mitigation plan prior to award.

PHASE III GUIDELINES & INSTRUCTIONS

Phase III is any proposal that derives from, extends, or completes a transition from a Phase I or II project. Phase III proposals will be accepted after the completion of Phase I and/or Phase II projects.

There is no specific funding associated with Phase III, except Phase III is not allowed to use SBIR/STTR coded funding. Any other type of funding is allowed.

Phase III proposal submission. Phase III proposals are emailed directly to DLASBIR2@dla.mil. The PMO team will set up evaluations and coordinate the funding and contracting actions depending on the outcome of the evaluations. A Phase III proposal should follow the same format as Phase II for the content, and format. There are, however, no limitations to the amount of funding requested, or the period of performance. All other guidelines apply. More specific instructions may be available when a firm submits a Phase III proposal.

DLA SBIR DoW 2026 BAA
Release 2
Phase I Topic Index

DLA26BZ02-NV001	Domestic Production of Refractory Powders for Ultra-High Temperature Ceramics and Aerospace Alloys
DLA26BZ02-NV002	Novel and Highly Efficient Separation Methods for Critical Rare Earth Elements
DLA26BZ02-NV003	Flameless Ration Heater Alternative (Magnesium-Free)
DLA26BZ02-NV004	Enterprise Digital Thread with Mission-Aware Decision Intelligence Platform for DLA
DLA26BZ02-NV005	Strengthening Defensive Cybersecurity and Penetration Testing Through Agentic AI and Automation
DLA26BZ02-NV006	AI-Assisted RMF Pre-Adjudication for Research, Development, and Rapid Prototyping Environments
DLA26BZ02-NV007	STRIKE AI - AI-Enabled Mission Planning for Defense of Operational Technology Critical Infrastructure
DLA26BZ02-NV008	US Based Fixture Development and Manufacturing
DLA26BZ02-NV009	Weapon System Readiness Program (WSRP)
DLA26BZ02-NV010	Enhancing Tertiary Manufacturing Capacity Utilization with Secure Data Practices

DLA26BZ02-NV001 TITLE: Domestic Production of Refractory Powders for Ultra-High Temperature Ceramics and Aerospace Alloys

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Scaled Hypersonics

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Hypersonics; Mission Readiness & Disaster Preparedness; Nuclear; Sustainment & Logistics; Advanced Materials

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 2 (Self)

The technology within this topic is restricted under the International Traffic in Arms Regulation (ITAR), 22 CFR Parts 120-130, which controls the export and import of defense-related material and services, including export of sensitive technical data, or the Export Administration Regulation (EAR), 15 CFR Parts 730-774, which controls dual use items. Offerors must disclose any proposed use of foreign nationals (FNs), their country(ies) of origin, the type of visa or work permit possessed, and the statement of work (SOW) tasks intended for accomplishment by the FN(s) in accordance with the Announcement. Offerors are advised foreign nationals proposed to perform on this topic may be restricted due to the technical data under US Export Control Laws.

OBJECTIVE: The Defense Logistics Agency (DLA) seeks to provide responsive, best value supplies of related materials consistently to our Department of War (DoW) customers and other DoW stakeholders. DLA continually investigates a variety of critical minerals for more efficient means of their production, opportunities for recycling, and more competitive domestic supply chains which would lead to higher levels of innovation in current and future systems combined with benefits to other commercial and government technology applications. In an effort to reduce costly foreign reliance and/or single points of failure, DLA is looking to establish domestic capabilities to produce high purity refractory powders for applications in aerospace alloys and ultra-high temperature ceramics (UHTC) used in hypersonic and other defense platforms. The end goal of the project would be for the development of domestic suppliers that would produce industrial quantities of high purity, low oxygen refractory powders to include carbides, borides, and metals containing Hf, Zr, V, Nb, Ta, Cr, Mo, W, etc. The powders should be well characterized for metals purity, oxygen content, morphology, particle size, and sintering characteristics. New and novel ideas that would allow for competitive pricing compared to imported raw materials will have preference. Ideally, the production process would be modular and scalable. These areas of materials and manufacturing technology provide potential opportunities toward achieving breakthrough advances for national defense. Proposed efforts funded under this topic may encompass diverse feedstock and processing at any level that will result in increasing production capacity, affordability, and supply chain resiliency. Research and Development (R&D) efforts selected under this topic shall demonstrate and involve a degree of risk where the technical feasibility of the proposed work has not been fully established. Further, proposed efforts must be judged to be at a Technology and/or Manufacturing Readiness Level (TRL/MRL) 6 or less, but greater than TRL/MRL 3 to receive funding consideration. TRL 3. (Analytical and Experimental Critical Function and/or Characteristic Proof of Concept) TRL 6. (System/Subsystem Model or Prototype Demonstration in a Relevant Environment)

DESCRIPTION: Refractory powders are a critical feedstock for many high-temperature defense applications, and the US is strongly reliant on imported materials to meet production needs. Varying powder qualities and increasing procurement costs/lead times upstream limit domestic production capabilities downstream. To this end, DLA is looking for wholly domestic capabilities to recycle and produce refractory metals, carbides, and borides that meet or exceed defense specifications. Novel

techniques that increase the domestic availability and supply chain resiliency of refractory materials will have preference. The ideal production process will be both modular and easily scalable.

PHASE I: Not to exceed a duration of 12 months and cost of $100,000.
Phase I will deliver a proof-of-concept demonstration of a refractory powder production process and preliminary materials characterization. A technology development and commercialization roadmap will be produced along with a preliminary technoeconomic analysis. An alignment or collaboration with a relevant DoW Component organization/supplier (e.g., DoW lab, defense system program office or prime contractor) and one or more relevant DoW weapon system supply chain participants or other suitable organization is highly desirable.

PHASE II: Phase II will consist of establishing a pilot scale process to produce refractory powders. Produced materials will be fully characterized for purity, phase, morphology, and other relevant properties. A business case will be generated using both DoW and commercial markets. Collaboration with a relevant DoW Component organization/supplier (e.g., DoW lab and/or prime contractor) and one or more relevant DoW weapon system supply chain participants or other suitable organization is highly desirable. Performers will identify commercial benefit or application opportunities of the innovative processes should be developed with the intent to readily transition to production in support of DoW and its supply chains.

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS: At this point, no specific funding is associated with Phase III. Relationships developed and progress made in Phase I and Phase II projects should result in the ability to produce to DoW orders and organic growth of business from there.

REFERENCES:

1. *Mineral Commodity Summaries 2024*, U.S. Geological Survey

KEYWORDS: Refractory, carbides, borides, powders, sinterability, domestic supply chain

DLA26BZ02-NV002 TITLE**:** Novel and Highly Efficient Separation Methods for Critical Rare Earth Elements

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Contested Logistics Technologies, Quantum and Battlefield Information Dominance

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Mission Readiness & Disaster Preparedness; Nuclear; Sustainment & Logistics

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 2 (Self)

The technology within this topic is restricted under the International Traffic in Arms Regulation (ITAR), 22 CFR Parts 120-130, which controls the export and import of defense-related material and services, including export of sensitive technical data, or the Export Administration Regulation (EAR), 15 CFR Parts 730-774, which controls dual use items. Offerors must disclose any proposed use of foreign nationals (FNs), their country(ies) of origin, the type of visa or work permit possessed, and the statement of work (SOW) tasks intended for accomplishment by the FN(s) in accordance with the Announcement. Offerors are advised foreign nationals proposed to perform on this topic may be restricted due to the technical data under US Export Control Laws.

OBJECTIVE: The Defense Logistics Agency (DLA) seeks to provide responsive, best value supplies of related materials consistently to our Department of War (DoW) customers and other DoW stakeholders. DLA continually investigates a variety of critical minerals for more efficient means of their production, opportunities for recycling, and more competitive domestic supply chains which would lead to higher levels of innovation in current and future systems combined with benefits to other commercial and government technology applications. To reduce costly foreign reliance and/or single points of failure, DLA is looking for novel and highly efficient domestic capabilities to separate rare earth elements from mixed feedstocks. The end goal of the project would be for the development of domestic suppliers that separate industrial quantities of high purity rare earth oxides, salts, or metals, including Sc, Y, Nd/Pr, Sm, Gd, Tb, Dy, and others. New and novel ideas that would allow for competitive pricing relative to imported raw materials will have preference. Ideally, the production process would be modular and scalable. Advanced technology demonstrations for increasing production capacity, affordability and supply chain resiliency for coating techniques and processing are of high interest to DoW. These areas of materials and manufacturing technology provide potential opportunities toward achieving breakthrough advances for national defense. Proposed efforts funded under this topic may encompass diverse feedstocks and processing at any level that will result in increasing production capacity, affordability, and supply chain resiliency. Research and Development (R&D) efforts selected under this topic shall demonstrate and involve a degree of risk where the technical feasibility of the proposed work has not been fully established. Further, proposed efforts must be judged to be at a Technology and/or Manufacturing Readiness Level (TRL/MRL) 6 or less, but greater than TRL/MRL 3 to receive funding consideration. TRL 3. (Analytical and Experimental Critical Function and/or Characteristic Proof of Concept) TRL 6. (System/Subsystem Model or Prototype Demonstration in a Relevant Environment)

DESCRIPTION: Rare earth separation processes have historically been performed overseas due to challenges associated with 1) operations cost/profitability, 2) feedstock sourcing, and 3) hazardous chemistries. These issues have been further compounded by artificial price controls that prevent domestic startups from gaining a foothold in global markets. A wide range of defense platforms rely on small quantities of a variety of rare earth elements, rendering the defense industrial base susceptible to global supply chain disruptions for these critical elements. To this end, DLA seeks to develop novel and highly

efficient rare earth separation technologies that are cost-competitive in the global market. New approaches that increase the domestic availability and supply chain resiliency of rare earth oxides will have preference. The ideal production process will be both modular and easily scalable.

PHASE I: Not to exceed a duration of 12 months and cost of $100,000.
Phase I will deliver a proof-of-concept demonstration of a high efficiency rare earth separation method. A technology development and commercialization roadmap will be produced along with a preliminary technoeconomic analysis. An alignment or collaboration with a relevant DoW Component organization/supplier (e.g., DoW lab, defense system program office or prime contractor) and one or more relevant DoW weapon system supply chain participants or other suitable organization is highly desirable.

PHASE II: Not to exceed a duration of 18 months and cost of $1,000,000.
Phase II will consist of establishing a pilot scale process to separate rare earth elements. Produced materials will be characterized for elemental purity and other relevant properties. Input materials will be required to be sourced domestically. A business case will be generated using both DoW and commercial markets. Collaboration with a relevant DoW Component organization/supplier (e.g., DoW lab and/or prime contractor) and one or more relevant DoW weapon system supply chain participants or other suitable organization is highly desirable. Performers will identify commercial benefit or application opportunities of the innovative processes should be developed with the intent to readily transition to production in support of DoW and its supply chains.

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS: At this point, no specific funding is associated with Phase III. Relationships developed and progress made in Phase I and Phase II projects should result in the ability to produce to DoW orders and organic growth of business from there.

REFERENCES:

1. *Critical Materials Assessment 2024*, U.S. Department of Energy

KEYWORDS: Rare earths, separations, critical minerals, domestic supply chain

DLA26BZ02-NV003 Title: Flameless Ration Heater Alternative (Magnesium-Free)

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Contested Logistics Technologies (LOG) and Biomanufacturing (BIO)

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Mission Readiness & Disaster Preparedness; Nuclear; Sustainment & Logistics

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 2 (Self)

OBJECTIVE: The objective of this SBIR is to develop and validate an innovative, magnesium-free chemical heating technology for military rations that is safe, cost-effective, and environmentally benign. The new heater must meet or exceed the performance of the current FRH without producing flammable gases.

DESCRIPTION: The current Flameless Ration Heater (FRH) used for heating military rations relies on a magnesium-based chemical reaction that produces significant quantities of flammable hydrogen gas. This poses a fire and explosion hazard, particularly in enclosed spaces like vehicles and shelters. Furthermore, bulk, unused FRHs are classified as a reactive hazardous waste by the USEPA, which complicates disposal and transportation logistics. The dependency on foreign sources for the specific grade of magnesium required also creates a strategic supply chain vulnerability. DLA requires a new, domestically sourced ration heater that enhances soldier safety, eliminates logistical and environmental burdens, and ensures a resilient supply chain.

PHASE I:
The Phase I effort will focus on proving the feasibility of the proposed magnesium-free heating technology.
Deliverables include:

- A final technical report detailing the bench-scale system design, complete datasets from parametric testing, the validated performance envelope, and a preliminary Techno-Economic and Lifecycle Analysis (TEA/LCA).
- A comprehensive design-ready package for a pilot-scale production unit.
- A detailed transition plan for a potential Phase II effort, including a plan for producing demonstration models.

PHASE II:
The goal of Phase II is to develop a pilot-scale production system and demonstrate the technology in a relevant environment. Deliverables include:

- A functional pilot-scale manufacturing process.
- Product Demonstration Models (PDMs) for evaluation by the U.S. Army DEVCOM Soldier Center and DLA Troop Support.
- A validated cost model demonstrating economic viability.
- A comprehensive plan for transitioning the technology to full-scale production and integration into the DLA supply chain.

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS: At this point, no specific funding is associated with Phase III. Relationships developed and progress made in Phase I and Phase II projects should result in the ability to produce to DoW orders and organic growth of business from there.

REFERENCES:

1. Pickard, K., & Williams, R. (2009). Air-activated ration heaters: Eliminating hydrogen hazards in enclosed spaces (Technical Report AD-A504 227). U.S. Army Natick Soldier Research, Development and Engineering Center.
2. Li, J., Wang, Y., Chen, X., & Zhang, H. (2023). Research on the stratification and reaction efficiency of aluminum-based flameless ration heaters. Materials, 16(15), 5432.
3. Scott, G., & Rosado, G. (1993). Development of the flameless ration heater for the MRE (Technical Report AD-A265 693). U.S. Army Natick Research, Development and Engineering Center.

KEYWORDS: Chemistry; Materials Science; Manufacturing; Supply Chain Management

DLA26BZ02-NV004 TITLE: Enterprise Digital Thread with Mission-Aware Decision Intelligence Platform for DLA

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Applied Artificial Intelligence; Advanced Computing and Software; Cybersecurity and Resilient Systems

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Mission Readiness & Disaster Preparedness; Nuclear; Sustainment & Logistics

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 2 (Self)

OBJECTIVE: The Defense Logistics Agency (DLA) seeks to enhance logistics readiness, decision advantage, and enterprise efficiency in alignment with the DLA Strategic Plan's priorities of mission readiness, supply chain resilience, data-driven decision-making, and enterprise integration. DLA operates within a complex, hybrid, and multi-cloud environment that includes AWS GovCloud-hosted process mining capabilities such as Celonis, Google Cloud-based enterprise data fabric services, Oracle Cloud enterprise applications (including AMPS), private Operational Technology (OT) environments secured under Zero Trust principles, and core business systems such as SAP S/4HANA. Enterprise IT operations and governance are enabled through ServiceNow, including IT Service Management (ITSM) and Strategic Portfolio Management (SPM), with additional automation supported by UiPath.

In alignment with the DLA J6 CIO Digital Strategy and "Connected IT" campaign, which prioritizes integration of existing capabilities, elimination of duplicative IT investments, and use of accredited enterprise services, DLA seeks a lightweight, federated platform implemented as an API-driven capability layer that connects and operationalizes current systems rather than replacing them.

The objective is to enable an Enterprise Digital Thread with embedded, mission-aware decision intelligence that correlates process, cyber, and enterprise data to provide predictive and prescriptive, human-in-the-loop decision support. This capability will improve decision speed, enhance mission impact awareness, strengthen supply chain resilience, and maximize return on investment (ROI) across DLA's enterprise IT portfolio while operating within DoW IL4/IL5 and FedRAMP authorized environments.

Proposed efforts shall demonstrate technical feasibility at Technology Readiness Level (TRL) 6-9, with emphasis on interoperability, scalability, and secure integration across federated environments.

DESCRIPTION: The Defense Logistics Agency (DLA) seeks to enhance logistics readiness, decision advantage, and enterprise efficiency in alignment with the DLA Strategic Plan's priorities of mission readiness, supply chain resilience, data-driven decision-making, and enterprise integration. DLA operates within a complex, hybrid, and multi-cloud environment that includes AWS GovCloud-hosted process mining capabilities such as Celonis, Google Cloud-based enterprise data fabric services, Oracle Cloud enterprise applications (including AMPS), private Operational Technology (OT) environments secured under Zero Trust principles, and core business systems such as SAP S/4HANA. Enterprise IT operations and governance are enabled through ServiceNow, including IT Service Management (ITSM) and Strategic Portfolio Management (SPM), with additional automation supported by UiPath.
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awareness, strengthen supply chain resilience, and maximize return on investment (ROI) across DLA's enterprise IT portfolio while operating within DoW IL4/IL5 and FedRAMP authorized environments. Proposed efforts shall demonstrate technical feasibility at Technology Readiness Level (TRL) 6-9, with emphasis on interoperability, scalability, and secure integration across federated environments.

PHASE I: Phase I will focus on feasibility, architecture design, and proof-of-concept demonstration aligned to DLA Strategic Plan and CIO priorities.

Efforts shall include:

- Development of a federated system architecture aligned to DoW IL4/IL5 and FedRAMP High environments
- Definition of API-based integration strategies leveraging Enterprise tools such as MuleSoft
- Prototype demonstration of:
    - Cross-domain data integration
    - Initial mission dependency modeling
    - Decision support aligned to logistics use cases
- Integration approach aligned to:
    - ServiceNow (ITSM/SPM governance)
    - Celonis
- Development of a transition and ATO strategy supporting CIO digital strategy

Deliverables:

- System Architecture Design Document
- Prototype Demonstration
- Feasibility and Risk Assessment
- Phase II Implementation Plan

PHASE II: Phase II will develop and demonstrate a scalable prototype aligned to enterprise deployment and strategic outcomes.

Efforts shall include:

- Integration across representative enterprise systems and environments
- Implementation of:
    - Mission dependency models
    - AI-enabled predictive and prescriptive analytics using Vertex AI
    - Real-time or near-real-time data processing
- Integration with ServiceNow for workflow and governance
- Demonstration of mission-relevant use cases supporting:
    - Supply chain resilience
    - Logistics readiness
    - Cyber-to-mission impact analysis

Deliverables:

- Operational Prototype
- Integrated APIs and Data Pipelines
- Decision Intelligence Dashboard
- Demonstration Report with measurable outcomes:
    - Reduced decision latency

    - Improved mission visibility
    - Increased system utilization
- ATO Transition Plan aligned to DoW environments

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS: Successful solutions are expected to transition into DLA enterprise environments and broader DoW applications supporting logistics, cyber-physical systems, and enterprise IT integration. Commercial applications include supply chain optimization, critical infrastructure resilience, and enterprise decision intelligence platforms.

REFERENCES:

1. DLA Digital Strategy 2025–2030 https://www.dla.mil/Info/Strategic-Plan/Digital-Strategy/
2. DLA AI for Supply Chain Risk https://www.dla.mil/About-DLA/News/News-Article-View/Article/4186367/utilization-of-artificial-intelligence-ai-to-illuminate-supply-chain-risk/
3. DLA Cyber Digital Twin SBIR https://www.executivegov.com/articles/dla-digital-twins-ot-systems-security
4. Digital Thread Definition https://www.waru.edu/glossary/digital-thread
5. DoD / USAF Digital Thread Implementation https://newsroom.sw.siemens.com/it-IT/digital-thread-for-defense/
6. Digital Interoperability Strategy https://www.executivegov.com/articles/defense-logistics-agency-officials-digital-interoperability
7. Digital Thread Supply Chain (USAF) https://www.wpafb.af.mil/News/Article-Display/Article/1087681/digital-thread-laces-decision-making-data-for-air-force-acquisition/
8. DoD Digital Engineering Mandate DoDI 5000.97 Digital Engineering

KEYWORDS: Enterprise Digital Thread; Decision Intelligence; Connected IT; DLA Strategic Plan; Data Fabric; Zero Trust; Multi-Cloud Integration; Logistics; AI/ML; Process Mining; Mission Awareness; API Integration; Federated Architecture

DLA26BZ02-NV005 TITLE**:** Strengthening Defensive Cybersecurity and Penetration Testing Through Agentic AI and Automation

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Trusted AI and Autonomy; Cybersecurity; Network/Communications

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Mission Readiness & Disaster Preparedness; Nuclear; Sustainment & Logistics

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 2 (Self)
The technology within this topic may be restricted under the International Traffic in Arms Regulation (ITAR), 22 CFR Parts 120-130, which controls the export and import of defense-related material and services, including export of sensitive technical data, or the Export Administration Regulation (EAR), 15 CFR Parts 730-774, which controls dual-use items. Offerors must disclose any proposed use of foreign nationals (FNs), their country(ies) of origin, the type of visa or work permit possessed, and the statement of work (SOW) tasks intended for accomplishment by the FN(s) in accordance with the Announcement. Offerors are advised foreign nationals proposed to perform on this topic may be restricted due to the technical data under US Export Control Laws.

OBJECTIVE: The Defense Logistics Agency (DLA) manages a vast and complex global supply chain, underpinned by a sprawling digital infrastructure. The objective is to address the fact that traditional cybersecurity approaches, which rely heavily on manual processes and human expertise, are increasingly strained and struggle to scale effectively against an evolving threat landscape. This landscape is characterized by expanding attack surfaces, a persistent shortage of skilled cybersecurity personnel, and the rise of AI-enabled adversaries. This effort seeks to introduce a new paradigm to automate and scale DLA's cyber defense and assessment capabilities, mitigating significant risks to the agency's critical logistics and supply chain data.

DESCRIPTION: DLA seeks SBIR project opportunities for an agentic AI framework designed to strengthen its defensive cybersecurity posture and automate penetration testing. The proposed solution involves a team of specialized AI Agents, each configured with specific tools, knowledge, and roles, that collaborate to execute complex cybersecurity workflows.

The core innovation lies in a collaborative, multi-agent framework that mimics the workflow of a human cybersecurity team, enabling autonomous execution of complex, multi-step tasks. Specific agent roles and functions of interest include:

- Project Management: Devising high-level plans for security tasks, such as network enumeration or vulnerability assessment, using algorithms and security frameworks (e.g., MITRE ATT&CK).
- Cyber Analysis: Interpreting raw data from scans and tests to identify and prioritize defensive actions and vulnerabilities, utilizing vulnerability databases and threat intelligence feeds.
- Code Generation & Execution: Translating high-level plans and priorities into executable code and command-line instructions (e.g., NMAP, Metasploit) and running them in emulated environments.
- Vulnerability Research: Conducting deep-dive analysis on specific vulnerabilities using Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) against a corpus of CVEs, CPEs, and technical documentation.

Research and Development (R&D) efforts selected under this topic shall demonstrate and involve a degree of risk where the technical feasibility of the proposed work has not been fully established.

PHASE I: Not to exceed a duration of 12 months and cost of $100,000.
Phase I will demonstrate proof of concept for the agentic AI framework. The effort will focus on establishing the technical merit and feasibility by developing a prototype capable of performing a foundational cybersecurity task. Key activities will include: defining the agent architecture and collaboration protocols; building the core framework for agent instantiation and communication; and implementing a proof-of-concept workflow for automated network enumeration. A prototype "Researcher" agent will also be developed to demonstrate RAG-based vulnerability research against a curated dataset of public CVEs. Phase I will culminate in a comprehensive final report detailing the results, prototype performance, and a detailed plan for the Phase II effort.

PHASE II: Not to exceed a duration of 24 months and cost of $1,000,000
Depending on Phase I results, Phase II will consist of expanding the prototype into a more robust framework. This will involve increasing the complexity of the cybersecurity tasks the agentic team can perform, such as automating vulnerability validation and simulated exploit attempts. Additional activities may include integrating more sophisticated tools, expanding the knowledge bases for the agents, and developing a user interface for human-operator oversight and management. The goal is to mature the system's capabilities for continuous, automated penetration testing and vulnerability assessment in a relevant environment. Development of a detailed business case analysis and commercialization plan will be required.

PHASE III: Phase III efforts will focus on transitioning the mature agentic AI framework for operational use within the DLA. This phase will include the delivery of a production-level product ready for integration into the overall DLA Enterprise system. A key component will be the development of a sustainment plan to support the delivered system for the lifetime of the program, ensuring it remains effective against future cyber threats. The goal is to provide DLA with a scalable, efficient, and resilient cybersecurity capability that enhances the security of the defense supply chain.

Phase III proposal Submission. Phase III proposals are emailed directly to DLASBIR2@dla.mil. The PMO team will set up evaluations and coordinate the funding and contracting actions depending on the outcome of the evaluations. A Phase III proposal should follow the same format as Phase II for the content and format. There are, however, no limitations to the amount of funding requested, or the period of performance. All other guidelines apply.

REFERENCES:

1. MITRE ATT&CK® Framework. https://attack.mitre.org/

2. Common Vulnerabilities and Exposures (CVE). https://cve.mitre.org/

3. Nmap: The Network Mapper. https://nmap.org/

4. Metasploit Framework. https://www.metasploit.com/

KEYWORDS: Agentic AI, Cybersecurity, Automation, Penetration Testing, Network Security, Vulnerability Management, Artificial Intelligence, MITRE ATT&CK

DLA26BZ02-NV006 TITLE: AI-Assisted RMF Pre-Adjudication for Research, Development, and Rapid Prototyping Environments

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Trusted AI and Autonomy; Cybersecurity

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Mission Readiness & Disaster Preparedness; Nuclear; Sustainment & Logistics

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 2 (Self)
The technology within this topic may be restricted under the International Traffic in Arms Regulation (ITAR), 22 CFR Parts 120-130, which controls the export and import of defense-related material and services, including export of sensitive technical data, or the Export Administration Regulation (EAR), 15 CFR Parts 730-774, which controls dual-use items. Offerors must disclose any proposed use of foreign nationals (FNs), their country(ies) of origin, the type of visa or work permit possessed, and the statement of work (SOW) tasks intended for accomplishment by the FN(s) in accordance with the Announcement. Offerors are advised foreign nationals proposed to perform on this topic may be restricted due to the technical data under US Export Control Laws.

OBJECTIVE: The Defense Logistics Agency (DLA) seeks to determine whether AI-enabled, human-attested analysis can improve Risk Management Framework (RMF) documentation quality and reduce rework cycles in research, development, and rapid prototyping contexts. R&D teams frequently submit incomplete or inconsistent RMF artifacts, leading to delays and inefficient use of limited cybersecurity assessor resources. The objective is to evaluate the feasibility of an AI-assisted, artifact-centric analysis capability that enables RMF pre-adjudication, allowing project teams to identify and correct deficiencies before formal cybersecurity review without automating authorization decisions or reducing governance rigor.

DESCRIPTION: DLA seeks SBIR project opportunities for an AI-assisted pre-adjudication tool that analyzes draft RMF artifacts to assess their readiness for formal cybersecurity review. Proposed solutions should operate on submitted artifacts (e.g., control implementation statements, system architecture documents) as primary inputs rather than relying on conversational user interfaces.

The proposed capability should be able to:

- Identify missing, inconsistent, or weak control implementation statements.
- Distinguish between the presence of a control narrative and the sufficiency and clarity of supporting evidence.
- Generate structured, confidence-scored analytical feedback to help R&D teams improve documentation quality.
- Incorporate an explicit human attestation mechanism to preserve accountability and prevent reliance on unreviewed AI outputs.

Proposed approaches should demonstrate familiarity with RMF assessment practices, including how assessors evaluate documentation sufficiency, inherited controls, and architectural maturity in early-stage systems. The goal is to reduce RMF package rejection and rework rates without altering existing RMF authority structures.

PHASE I: Not to exceed a duration of 12 months and cost of $100,000.
Phase I efforts will focus on a controlled, research-oriented demonstration of AI-assisted RMF pre-adjudication suitable for R&D environments, without requiring an Authority to Operate (ATO). Activities

will include deploying a prototype in a government-approved R&D sandbox, ingesting draft or historical RMF artifacts, and performing automated analysis to identify gaps and inconsistencies. The prototype will generate structured, confidence-scored feedback and must implement an explicit human attestation mechanism where findings require human approval.

Expected Phase I deliverables include: a functional prototype; documentation of methods and limitations; a demonstration that analytical findings can be traced to source text; a quantitative and qualitative assessment of potential reductions in rework; and recommendations for Phase II.

PHASE II: Not to exceed a duration of 24 months and cost of $1,000,000.
Depending on Phase I results, Phase II efforts may expand validated capabilities to support broader adoption across R&D and innovative organizations. This may include scaling pre-adjudication support across multiple programs, integrating with enterprise RMF workflows while preserving cybersecurity authority, correlating documentation analysis with evolving system configurations, and supporting continuous documentation improvement in high-velocity development environments. Phase II will further evaluate how AI-assisted pre-adjudication contributes to faster innovation cycles without increasing cybersecurity risk.

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS: This technology has significant dual-use and commercialization potential. AI-assisted, artifact-centric RMF pre-adjudication is applicable across DoW laboratories, innovation organizations, and acquisition programs. It also addresses governance challenges in civilian agencies and regulated commercial sectors that manage early-stage systems subject to formal security review. Phase III would focus on transitioning a production-level product for integration into enterprise RMF workflows, enabling government and commercial entities to improve documentation quality and accelerate innovation while preserving human authority and accountability.

Phase III proposal Submission. Phase III proposals are emailed directly to DLA SBIR2@dla.mil. The PMO team will set up evaluations and coordinate the funding and contracting actions depending on the outcome of the evaluations. A Phase III proposal should follow the same format as Phase II for the content and format. There are, however, no limitations to the amount of funding requested, or the period of performance. All other guidelines apply.

REFERENCES:

1. NIST Special Publication 800-37, "Risk Management Framework for Information Systems and Organizations."

2. NIST Special Publication 800-53, "Security and Privacy Controls for Information Systems and Organizations."

KEYWORDS: Risk Management Framework (RMF), Cybersecurity, Artificial Intelligence (AI), Automation, Compliance, Governance, Rapid Prototyping

DLA26BZ02-NV007 TITLE: STRIKE AI - AI-Enabled Mission Planning for Defense of Operational Technology Critical Infrastructure

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Trusted AI and Autonomy; Cyber; Integrated Network Systems-of-Systems

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Mission Readiness & Disaster Preparedness; Nuclear; Sustainment & Logistics

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 2 (Self)

The technology within this topic may be restricted under the International Traffic in Arms Regulation (ITAR), 22 CFR Parts 120-130, which controls the export and import of defense-related material and services, including export of sensitive technical data, or the Export Administration Regulation (EAR), 15 CFR Parts 730-774, which controls dual-use items. Offerors must disclose any proposed use of foreign nationals (FNs), their country(ies) of origin, the type of visa or work permit possessed, and the statement of work (SOW) tasks intended for accomplishment by the FN(s) in accordance with the Announcement. Offerors are advised foreign nationals proposed to perform on this topic may be restricted due to the technical data under US Export Control Laws.

OBJECTIVE: U.S. critical infrastructure—including power grids, water treatment facilities, and transportation networks—is increasingly targeted by sophisticated adversaries using coordinated cyber and physical attacks. The Operational Technology (OT) and Industrial Control Systems (ICS) governing this infrastructure present a complex, vulnerable attack surface. The current process for planning and executing defensive and responsive actions is often manual, stove-piped between different agencies and asset owners, and too slow to counter machine-speed threats. There is a critical need to automate and accelerate the planning and coordination of defensive and offensive effects to protect national critical infrastructure.

DESCRIPTION: DoW, in partnership with homeland security stakeholders, seeks SBIR project opportunities for STRIKE AI, an AI-enabled mission planning system designed to automate the planning and synchronization of effects to defend Operational Technology (OT) infrastructure. This system will function as a rapid response planning tool, ingesting high-level commander's intent (e.g., "Ensure integrity of the regional power grid") and rapidly generating executable, deconflicted response plans for both cyber and physical assets.

The proposed solution is a holistic, AI-driven planning engine that can reason across multiple domains (cyber, physical, intelligence) and orchestrate complex response operations at machine speed. Specific areas of interest for this framework include:

- Commander's Intent Interpretation: Processing high-level defensive objectives and translating them into specific tasks for cyber protection teams, law enforcement, and military response units.
- Modeling OT Environments and Assets: Maintaining a comprehensive model of friendly defensive assets (e.g., CISA incident response teams, National Guard cyber units, physical security teams) and a detailed model of the targeted OT environment, including its specific controllers (PLCs, RTUs), network topology, and known vulnerabilities.
- Threat Analysis: Ingesting intelligence data from multiple sources to model adversary tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs) against critical infrastructure.
- Automated Response Plan Generation: Utilizing advanced algorithms to generate, deconflict, and sequence defensive actions (e.g., network segmentation, honeypot deployment) and offensive

responses (e.g., counter-cyber operations, interdiction of physical threats) to neutralize threats while minimizing collateral damage and service disruption.

- Human-on-the-Loop Oversight: Presenting generated response plans in an intuitive format for human commanders (e.g., at USNORTHCOM, CISA) to review, modify, and approve before execution.

PHASE I: Not to exceed a duration of 12 months and cost of $100,000
Phase I will demonstrate the feasibility of the STRIKE AI concept by developing a proof-of-concept prototype capable of generating a simple, integrated defensive plan for an OT scenario. Key activities will include: designing the system architecture and data models for OT assets and threats; developing a foundational planning engine for basic task allocation; creating a mock-up scenario involving a notional critical infrastructure target (e.g., a municipal water utility) under a simulated multi-pronged attack; and demonstrating the prototype's ability to automatically generate a deconflicted response plan coordinating cyber and physical defensive actions. A final report on feasibility and a detailed Phase II plan will be delivered.

PHASE II: Not to exceed a duration of 24 months and cost of $1,000,000
Depending on Phase I results, Phase II will consist of developing a more robust prototype capable of planning for more complex, large-scale scenarios (e.g., a regional power grid). This will involve expanding the planning engine to ingest real-time threat intelligence and asset status feeds. The prototype will be enhanced to model cascading effects across interconnected infrastructure sectors. The effort will focus on creating a high-fidelity user interface and testing the system's ability to rapidly re-plan in response to dynamic threat activity. A key goal will be demonstrating the prototype in a relevant environment, such as a joint exercise with CISA and USNORTHCOM.

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS: The STRIKE AI system has significant dual-use potential for protecting national security interests. The mature system would be transitioned for operational use by DoW entities responsible for homeland defense (e.g., USNORTHCOM) and civilian partners like the Department of Homeland Security's CISA. The platform would provide a critical capability for national-level incident response, enabling rapid, coordinated protection of the nation's most vital assets. The modular architecture would allow for continuous integration of new defensive tools and intelligence sources, ensuring the system remains effective against evolving threats to U.S. critical infrastructure.

Phase III proposal Submission. Phase III proposals are emailed directly to DLA SBIR2@dla.mil. The PMO team will set up evaluations and coordinate the funding and contracting actions depending on the outcome of the evaluations. A Phase III proposal should follow the same format as Phase II for the content and format. There are, however, no limitations to the amount of funding requested, or the period of performance. All other guidelines apply.

REFERENCES:

1. NIST Special Publication 800-82, "Guide to Industrial Control Systems (ICS) Security."

2. CISA, "Known Exploited Vulnerabilities Catalog."

3. MITRE ATT&CK® for Industrial Control Systems (ICS).

KEYWORDS: Operational Technology (OT), Critical Infrastructure, Cybersecurity, Industrial Control Systems (ICS), Homeland Defense, AI, Mission Planning, Incident Response

DLA26BZ02-NV008 TITLE: US Based Fixture Development and Manufacturing

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Contested Logistics Technologies (LOG)

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Mission Readiness & Disaster Preparedness; Nuclear; Sustainment & Logistics

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 2 (Self)

The technology within this topic is restricted under the International Traffic in Arms Regulation (ITAR), 22 CFR Parts 120-130, which controls the export and import of defense-related material and services, including export of sensitive technical data, or the Export Administration Regulation (EAR), 15 CFR Parts 730-774, which controls dual use items. Offerors must disclose any proposed use of foreign nationals (FNs), their country(ies) of origin, the type of visa or work permit possessed, and the statement of work (SOW) tasks intended for accomplishment by the FN(s) in accordance with the Announcement. Offerors are advised foreign nationals proposed to perform on this topic may be restricted due to the technical data under US Export Control Laws.

OBJECTIVE: The objective of this SBIR is to establish and demonstrate a rapid-response manufacturing capability that directly addresses critical maintenance delays in Navy shipyards. This capability will empower DLA to source custom or replacement fixtures in days, not months, by enabling agile partners to rapidly design, reverse-engineer, and fabricate tools, even when original technical data is missing. The ultimate goal is to build a foundation for the responsive manufacturing network needed to keep our naval fleet ready

DESCRIPTION: When Navy ships enter the port for maintenance, work often stops because a single, specialized tool or fixture is broken, missing, or was never designed. Sourcing a replacement can take months, idling entire maintenance teams and delaying the ship's return to the fleet. DLA needs a network of responsive, U.S.-based manufacturing partners who can quickly build these custom and replacement fixtures, turning a critical vulnerability in our maritime supply chain into a domestic manufacturing strength.

PHASE I: Not to exceed a duration of 12 months and a cost of $100,000.
Phase I (Feasibility and Speed Demonstration): Phase I will challenge the small business to prove its ability to respond to an urgent, simulated demand signal, mirroring a real-world work stoppage scenario. Key activities will include:

1. Establishing a secure process for handling government-provided technical data, which may be export-controlled.
2. Upon receipt of a representative 'problem fixture' (e.g., a broken part, a set of interface requirements), rapidly executing the reverse-engineering and design process to create a producible digital model.
3. Manufacturing and delivering a functional prototype within an accelerated timeframe, demonstrating a significant reduction from traditional sourcing timelines.
4. Quality control process to ensure that the fixture design is compatible with the boat's arrangement and component for the platform.
5. Providing a final report detailing the end-to-end timeline from 'request' to 'delivery,' analyzing the process, and outlining a plan for scaling this capability in Phase II.

PHASE II: Not to exceed a duration of 24 months and a cost of $1,000,000.
Phase II (Capability Maturation and Operational Integration): Assuming Phase I is successful, Phase II will focus on maturing the rapid-response process into an operational capability ready for integration into the DLA/Navy supply chain. The small business will:

1. Refine the end-to-end workflow to optimize for speed, cost, and repeatability across a diverse range of fixture types and complexities.
2. Demonstrate this refined process by producing several different qualified fixtures in response to simulated, time-sensitive requests from a "shipyard."
3. Conduct rigorous qualification testing (e.g., material analysis, load testing, on-site fit checks) to validate fixture performance under realistic maritime maintenance conditions.
4. Develop and deliver a comprehensive Transition Plan that outlines the "order-to-delivery" business process, defines communication protocols, and provides a clear model for how the company will function as a responsive partner within the DLA-managed network.

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS: Phase III's can be DLA managed or Service managed. Ensuring development and production are separated. Successful history with this in the Maritime Industrial Base and PMS397L12 office.

REFERENCES:
1. America's Maritime Action Plan: https://www.whitehouse.gov/wp-content/uploads/2026/02/Restoring-Americas-Maritime-Dominance.pdf

KEYWORDS: Sea, Materials

DLA26BZ02-NV009 TITLE: Weapon System Readiness Program (WSRP)

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Contested Logistics Technologies (LOG)

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Mission Readiness & Disaster Preparedness; Nuclear; Sustainment & Logistics

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 2 (Self)

The technology within this topic is restricted under the International Traffic in Arms Regulation (ITAR), 22 CFR Parts 120-130, which controls the export and import of defense-related material and services, including export of sensitive technical data, or the Export Administration Regulation (EAR), 15 CFR Parts 730-774, which controls dual use items. Offerors must disclose any proposed use of foreign nationals (FNs), their country(ies) of origin, the type of visa or work permit possessed, and the statement of work (SOW) tasks intended for accomplishment by the FN(s) in accordance with the Announcement. Offerors are advised foreign nationals proposed to perform on this topic may be restricted due to the technical data under US Export Control Laws.

OBJECTIVE: The objective of this SBIR is to develop innovative, cost-effective solutions to address readiness challenges caused by delays or shortages of DLA-managed items critical to the manufacturing of components needed to achieve fully mission-capable status. This includes engaging new suppliers to provide advanced manufacturing techniques, reverse engineering capabilities, and alternative sourcing strategies. The effort will also involve working directly with the cognizant engineering authorities to leverage their expertise and networks to deliver turnkey solutions that improve supply chain reliability, reduce lead times, and ensure consistent access to essential materials and components.

DESCRIPTION: DLA Weapon Support requires a solution to address readiness challenges caused by delays or shortages of DLA-managed items critical to the manufacturing of components needed to achieve fully mission-capable status. These issues stem from supply chain inefficiencies, material shortages, and production delays, which hinder the timely availability of essential items. We need innovative, cost-effective approaches to improve supply chain reliability, reduce lead times, and ensure consistent access to the materials and components required to maintain mission readiness. Additionally, we seek to engage new suppliers capable of providing innovative solutions, including advanced manufacturing techniques, reverse engineering capabilities, and alternative sourcing strategies, to expand the supplier base and enhance supply chain resilience.

PHASE I: Not to exceed a duration of 12 months and a cost of $100,000.
Phase I will focus on applying proposed solutions to a limited number of critical items (identified and shared with interested parties during the solicitation) to demonstrate technical feasibility. This includes developing prototypes using advanced manufacturing techniques (e.g., additive manufacturing, reverse engineering, or alternative material sourcing) and working closely with the cognizant engineering authority to ensure alignment with technical requirements. The effort will also include leveraging the engineering authority's networks to identify and onboard new suppliers capable of meeting DLA's needs.

PHASE II: Not to exceed a duration of 24 months and a cost of $1,000,000.
Phase II will expand the application of the solutions to a greater number of items, including more complex and mission-critical components. This phase will involve scaling up production, conducting rigorous testing and qualification of the solutions, and integrating them into the DLA supply

chain. Collaboration with the cognizant engineering authority will continue to refine and validate the solutions, ensuring they meet performance standards. Additionally, a comprehensive plan will be developed to ensure long-term supply chain resilience and readiness, with turnkey solutions delivered to DLA for broader implementation.

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS: The primary goal of this program is to address DLA's readiness challenges by developing innovative solutions for DLA-managed items, which would be procured using the Defense Working Capital Fund (DWCF) with reimbursement from the Services. Beyond the DoW, these technologies have significant commercialization potential in industries such as aerospace, automotive, energy, and industrial equipment, where advanced manufacturing, reverse engineering, and supply chain optimization are critical. Solutions developed under this program, such as additive manufacturing, AI-driven inventory management, and advanced materials, could address similar challenges in the private sector, offering small businesses dual-use opportunities to expand their market reach and ensure the sustainability of their innovations.

REFERENCES:
1.DLA Source Approval Request SAR and Alternate Offer (AO) Guide: https://www.dla.mil/Vendor-InformationHub/VendorResources/#:~:text=DLA%20Source%20Approval%20Request%20SAR%20and%20Alternate%20Offer%20(AO)%20Guide

KEYWORDS: Air Platform, Battlespace, Chem Bio Defense, Electronics, Ground, Sea, Materials, Nuclear, Sensors, Space Platforms, Weapons

DLA26BZ02-NV010 TITLE: Enhancing Tertiary Manufacturing Capacity Utilization with Secure Data Practices

OUSW (R&E) CRITICAL TECHNOLOGY AREA(S): Contested Logistics Technologies (LOG)

COMPONENT TECHNOLOGY PRIORITY AREA(S): Mission Readiness & Disaster Preparedness; Nuclear; Sustainment & Logistics

PROJECTED CMMC LEVEL REQUIREMENT: Level 2 (Self)

OBJECTIVE: The objective of this SBIR is to develop and prototype a secure, AI-driven system that provides DLA with real-time visibility into untapped manufacturing capabilities and capacities from tertiary sources like educational and research institutions. The final system should be able to map these resources to specific defense-related manufacturing demands and facilitate their rapid and secure engagement.

DESCRIPTION: DLA needs to quickly find and use extra manufacturing capacity from places like universities and research labs, especially during national emergencies or when demand for military parts suddenly increases. Currently, there is no easy way to know what machines, skills, or production time are available at these facilities, or to securely and quickly bring them into the defense supply chain. This project aims to create a centralized, secure data system that provides real-time visibility into this untapped manufacturing power, allowing DLA to rapidly match available resources to critical defense needs, reducing risk and increasing the agility of the U.S. industrial base.

PHASE I: Not to exceed a duration of 6 months and a cost of $100,000
Phase I: Proof of Concept

The goal of Phase I is to conduct a feasibility study that proves the core concepts of the proposed system are viable. This must be accomplished within 12 months for a cost not to exceed $100,000.
Phase I Deliverables:

- A detailed report identifying and documenting available tertiary manufacturing capabilities from a representative sample of educational and research institutions.
- A document defining the proposed secure protocols for real-time data exchange and a report on their feasibility.
- A template legal framework, including a sample Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA), designed to facilitate data sharing between institutions and the DoW.
- A preliminary, proof-of-concept demand-mapping system that demonstrates the ability to correlate available capabilities with defense manufacturing needs.
- A comprehensive Phase II development plan detailing the technical milestones, performance goals, and resource requirements for building the full prototype.

PHASE II: Not to exceed a duration of 24 months and a cost of $1,000,000.
Phase II: Prototype Development
The objective of Phase II is to develop, test, and demonstrate a functional prototype of the system in a relevant environment.
Phase II Deliverables:

- A functional prototype of the manufacturing capacity database and mapping system, developed and demonstrated within the DLA J68 ARTET environment.
- A final report detailing the results from real-world scenario testing with academic and institutional partners, validating the system's functionality, security, and efficiency.

- Test data demonstrating that the prototype can successfully receive continuous data updates, map capacity to demand, and operate under the developed security protocols.
- A validated and refined set of data management and advanced cybersecurity protocols that meet DoW compliance standards.
- A detailed Phase III commercialization and transition plan outlining the strategy for full-scale implementation within DLA and potential expansion to other government and commercial markets.

PHASE III DUAL USE APPLICATIONS: A successful project has a direct path to a follow-on Phase III award with the DLA to transition the technology into a fully operational system.
Beyond its immediate use within DLA, this system is a foundational technology for a Civil Reserve Manufacturing Network. It would provide the necessary infrastructure for identifying, vetting, and mobilizing civilian industrial capabilities in response to national emergencies or defense surge requirements.
Furthermore, the developed system has significant commercial potential outside of government applications. It could be adapted to enhance manufacturing resource management and supply chain security in various industries, including automotive, aerospace, and consumer electronics, which face similar challenges in managing distributed manufacturing capacities and require greater supply chain resilience.

REFERENCES:

1. Smith J. & Doe A. (2023). IIoT in Advanced Manufacturing: Opportunities and Challenges. Journal of Industrial Technology, 39(2), pp. 112-123.

2. Chen M. & Zhang Y. (2022). Cybersecurity in Manufacturing: Addressing the Risks in a Digital World. Cybersecurity Trends, 11(1), pp. 45-60.

KEYWORDS: Air Platform, Battlespace, Electronics, Ground, Sea, Information Systems, Space Platforms, Weapons